



Module 3: Social Media Platforms

Every platform has its own audience, culture, content formats, and purpose. A great social media marketer doesn't blindly post the same thing everywhere — they understand each platform first, then adapt their content accordingly.

THRM SOCIAL MEDIA COURSE

MODULE 3

Learning Objective

What You'll Know by the End of This Module

Platform Basics

Understand how each major platform works and what makes it unique.

Audience Insight

Know who uses each platform and why they show up there.

Content That Works

Identify which content formats perform best on each platform.

Smart Selection

Choose the right platform for a business based on goals and audience.



The most important lesson: Understand the platform first. Adapt the content second.

Why Understanding Platforms Matters

Imagine a business creates a 30-second funny Reel for Instagram. Technically, they could upload that same video to Facebook, LinkedIn, and YouTube. But it won't perform equally well on all four — because users behave differently on every platform.

→ Instagram

Users discover brands through visual Reels and aesthetic content.

→ LinkedIn

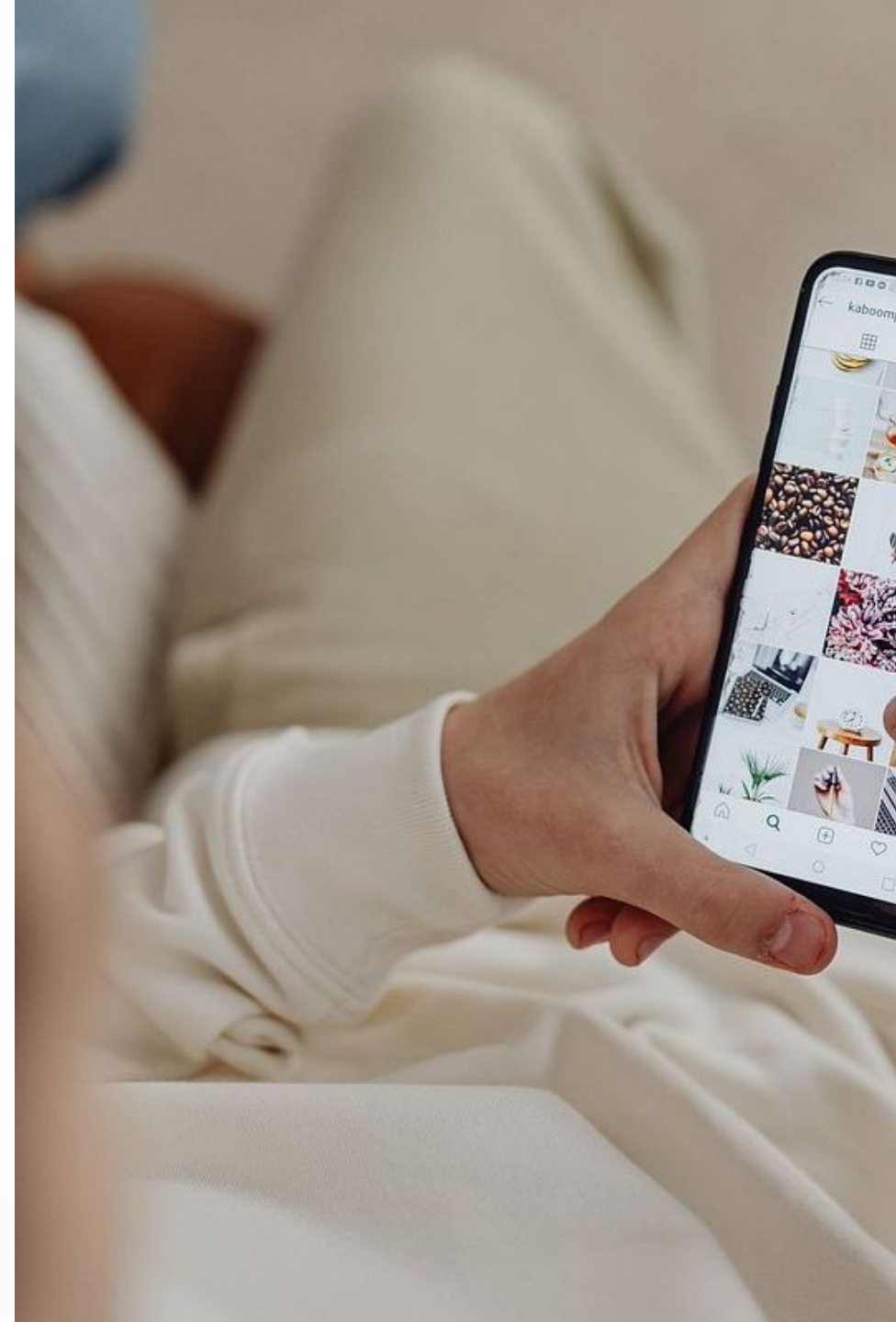
Users find companies through professional insights and case studies.

→ YouTube

Users search for in-depth tutorials and educational video content.

→ Facebook

Users engage with local businesses, groups, and communities.





Instagram: The Visual Discovery Platform

Instagram is a highly visual platform built around photos, videos, creators, brands, and communities. What makes it powerful for businesses is its **discovery engine** — users regularly find and follow new accounts through Reels, search, and recommendations, giving smaller brands a real shot at organic reach.

Content Formats

- Reels (short-form vertical video)
- Carousels (swipeable multi-image posts)
- Stories (temporary, frequent updates)
- Static posts, Live videos
- Collaborative & broadcast features

Businesses That Thrive Here

- Fashion, beauty & jewellery brands
- Restaurants, cafés & food businesses
- Fitness brands & makeup artists
- Travel, photography & personal brands
- Local businesses & creators

Instagram in Action: A Café Example

A local café doesn't need to only post promotional offers. A smart Instagram strategy mixes different types of content to build a genuine community around the brand.

1

Educational

"3 things to try if you're visiting our café for the first time."

2

Entertainment

A relatable Reel about the struggle of choosing what to order.

3

Lifestyle

An aesthetic ambience video that captures the café's vibe and feel.

4

Social Proof

Customer reviews or user-generated content shared from guests.

5

Promotional

A special weekend offer — used sparingly within the content mix.

Facebook: The Community & Connection Platform

Facebook is one of the most versatile platforms available. While it may feel older compared to Instagram or TikTok, it remains highly effective — especially for local businesses, community-driven brands, and businesses that rely on events, reviews, and group interaction.

What People Use Facebook For

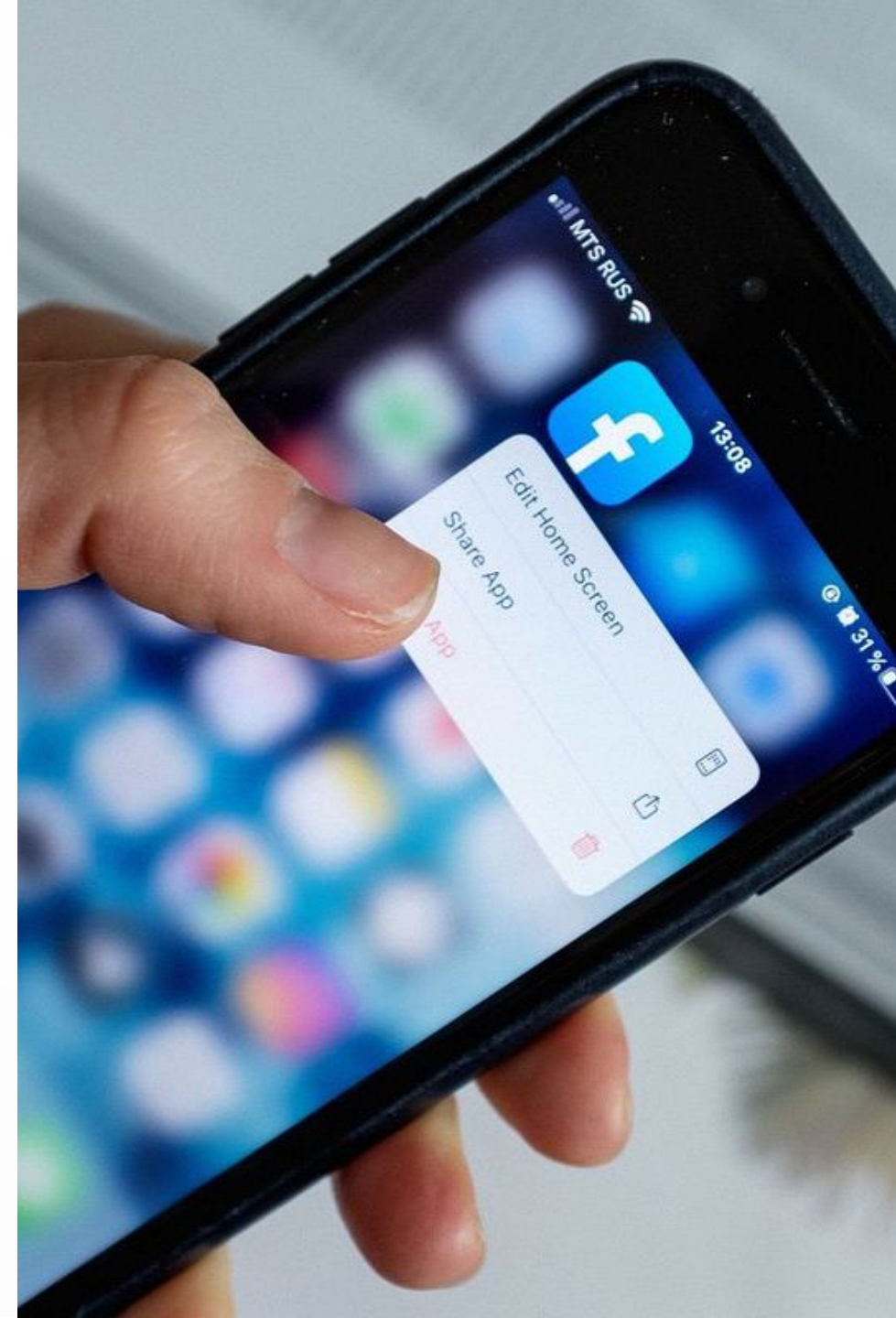
- Groups & local communities
- Business pages & reviews
- Events & announcements
- News, discussions & Marketplace
- Videos, Reels & brand communication

Best-Fit Businesses

- Local restaurants, clinics & service businesses
- Educational & coaching institutes
- Real estate & e-commerce brands
- Community-based & non-profit organisations

Facebook Strategy Formula

Information + Community +
Engagement + Local Relevance



LinkedIn: The Professional Networking Platform

LinkedIn is built for careers, business, and professional growth. It's the go-to platform for B2B marketing, thought leadership, recruitment, and industry authority — and it rewards content that educates, informs, and adds genuine professional value.



Who Uses LinkedIn

Founders, CEOs, recruiters, consultants, freelancers, students, and industry experts — all in one professional network.



What Businesses Use It For

B2B lead generation, employer branding, recruitment, company updates, thought leadership, and industry positioning.



Content That Works

Text posts, carousels, case studies, articles, short videos, client results, team stories, and founder opinions.

📄 LinkedIn content doesn't need to be stiff or formal. The best-performing posts are human, story-driven, and conversational — while staying relevant to a professional audience.

YouTube: The Search & Video Discovery Platform

YouTube is one of the world's most powerful search engines — second only to Google. Unlike other platforms where users scroll passively, YouTube users often arrive with a specific question or goal. This makes it ideal for businesses that can answer real questions through video content.

Example Search Intentions

- "How to create an Instagram content calendar"
- "Best camera for beginners"
- "How to use Canva for social media"
- "Beginner's guide to skincare routines"

Content YouTube Is Great For

- Long-form tutorials & how-to videos
- YouTube Shorts (vertical, short-form)
- Product demos & reviews
- Interviews, podcasts & vlogs
- Educational & expert content

A skincare brand could publish "Beginner's Guide to Building a Skincare Routine" — a viewer searches, discovers the brand, and becomes a customer.

Comparing the Four Major Platforms

This isn't about memorizing a table — it's about understanding that platform selection must be strategic. Each platform has a different purpose, audience, and content style.

Platform	Strong For	Common Content Formats
Instagram	Visual discovery, lifestyle, creators, brands	Reels, Stories, Carousels, Static Posts
Facebook	Communities, local businesses, broad audiences	Posts, Videos, Reels, Groups, Events
LinkedIn	Professional & B2B marketing, thought leadership	Text posts, Carousels, Videos, Case Studies
YouTube	Video, education, search, entertainment	Long videos, Shorts, Tutorials, Reviews

Choosing the Right Platform: A Strategic Framework

One of the biggest beginner mistakes is saying *"We should be on every platform."* Being everywhere without a strategy often leads to poor results everywhere. Instead, ask three foundational questions before selecting any platform.

1 Who Is the Target Audience?

Professionals and B2B decision-makers → LinkedIn. Fashion, beauty, or food lovers → Instagram. Broad local community → Facebook.

2 What Does the Business Sell?

Visually attractive product → Instagram. Complex software → YouTube tutorials + LinkedIn. Local services → Facebook + Instagram.

3 What Is the Business Goal?

Brand awareness → Instagram, YouTube, Facebook. B2B leads → LinkedIn. Education → YouTube. Local community → Facebook.

Platform-Specific Content: Same Idea, Different Execution

One of the most important concepts in this module: **one idea does not mean one identical piece of content everywhere.** Take a digital marketing agency with the topic: *"5 Social Media Mistakes Businesses Make."*

Instagram

Short Reel with quick visuals, bold text overlays, and a strong hook: "5 mistakes killing your reach."

Facebook

A slightly longer post or Reel with more context and a discussion-focused caption that invites comments.

LinkedIn

A professional text post with real examples and practical recommendations for business owners.

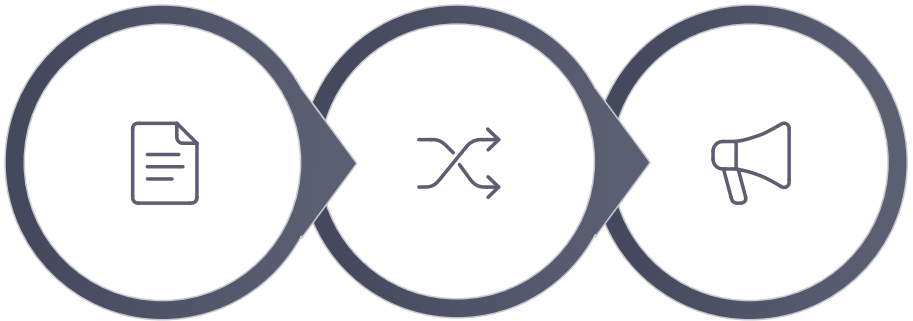
YouTube

A longer video explaining each mistake in depth with case study examples and actionable takeaways.

Same topic. Different execution. That's platform-specific content.

Content Repurposing: Work Smarter, Not Harder

Repurposing content is smart strategy. Copy-pasting content without adapting it is not. Take one valuable asset — like a 10-minute YouTube tutorial — and transform it into multiple pieces of platform-native content.



Create Core

Adapt
Platforms

Multiply
Reach

3

Instagram Reels
From one YouTube video

3

YouTube Shorts
Quick, punchy vertical clips

2

LinkedIn Posts
Key insights rephrased professionally

1

Facebook Video
Community-focused version

One Brand, Four Platform Strategies

A fitness brand is the same business on every platform — but its content strategy shifts dramatically based on where it's posting. Here's what platform-native thinking looks like in practice.

Instagram

Workout Reels, transformation stories, quick tips, and behind-the-scenes Stories that build community and inspire action.

Facebook

Community posts, local events, client testimonials, and group engagement to build loyalty among existing customers.

LinkedIn

Corporate wellness content, business partnerships, industry insights, and founder thought leadership.

YouTube

Full workout tutorials, educational fitness guides, nutrition explainers, and longer-form video content.



The 6-Question Platform Selection Framework

Before recommending platforms to any client, work through these six questions. If the answer to the last question is "no," adding that platform is probably not a good idea — yet.

01

Who is the target audience?

02

Where does this audience spend time online?

03

What type of content does this audience consume?

04

What does the business want to achieve?

05

What content can the business realistically produce?

06

Can the business consistently maintain this platform?



A strong strategy is not about being everywhere. It's about being effective where it matters.

Practical Exercise

Case Study: Premium Makeup Artist, Mumbai

Client Brief: Premium makeup artist based in Mumbai. Target audience: women aged 20–35, brides-to-be, and beauty enthusiasts. Goal: Generate bridal makeup enquiries.



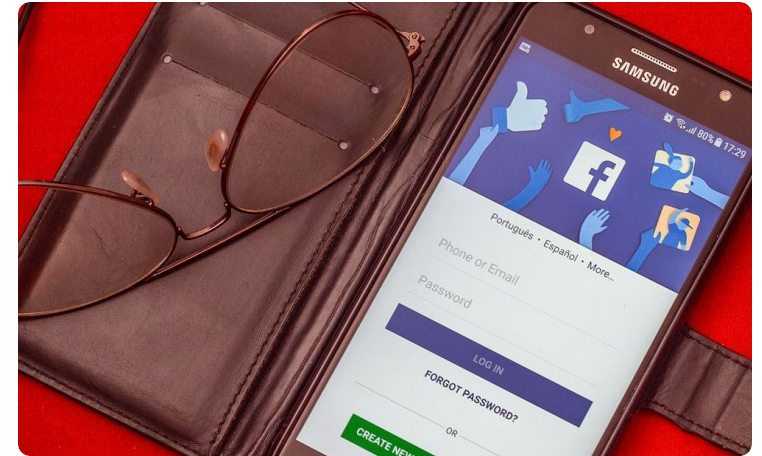
Primary: Instagram

Highly visual business with a visual audience. Reels, bridal transformation photos, Stories, and collaborations drive discovery and enquiries organically.



Secondary: YouTube

Bridal makeup tutorials, product explainers, and behind-the-scenes videos build authority and attract viewers searching for wedding beauty content.



Supporting: Facebook

Supports local awareness, community engagement, and paid advertising to reach brides-to-be in specific locations and age groups.

Key learning: Don't just choose platforms — explain *why* you chose them based on the audience, content type, and business goal.

Module 3: Quick Recap



Instagram

Visual discovery, creators, lifestyle brands, and communities.



Facebook

Communities, local businesses, groups, and broad audiences.



LinkedIn

Professional networking, B2B marketing, and thought leadership.



YouTube

Video, education, search-driven discovery, and entertainment.

✓ Platform selection depends on **target audience, business goals, content type, and available resources.**

✓ The same content idea can be repurposed — but **repurposing means adapting, not copy-pasting.**

✓ A successful marketer understands **the platform, the audience, and the business goal together.**

THRM Beginner Tip: Don't ask, "Where can we post this?" Ask, "Where will this content make the most sense?"